us!’ This made us laugh, but in a light-hearted yet assertive tone we replied, ‘Yes, for sure!’ This is true—the freedom of the people’s movements and the importance of a ‘dialogue-driven’ approach with political parties was thus maintained. The various roles of the organizations related to the Yatra and their context-based methodologies were noticed by us too.

What Next after the Yatra? The Way Ahead

Spanning states and regions, the Yatra offered a platform for local issues to be raised—to Rahul Gandhi as well as to state and local leaders. We all hope they have learnt from this experience and internalized it. India needs an alternative to stand up for their voices and to stand against the politics of adharmik (non-religious) violence and communal hatred across the country, which bulldozes minorities and citizens (who are not even allowed to express their constitutional rights). We were hopeful that a galaxy of Muslim and Christian communities would swell the ranks of the Yatra. After all, given what they were facing, they needed and wanted to join. But this was not to be. Was it because Rahul consciously avoided speaking about riots and the destruction they caused even in areas where they took place (such as in Madhya Pradesh)? Was it because the Yatra overlooked those patriotic citizens who were languishing in jail for spurious reasons? Similarly, Rahul Gandhi spoke on multiple occasions about the right of the Adivasi to ‘*jal, jameen aur jungle* (water, land and forest)’. But there was no mention of the violent attacks on the Adivasi in states such as Madhya Pradesh. No Congress or non-Congress leaders held any briefings on these deplorable events. Maybe it was because they wanted to avoid any provocation, presumably to avoid any clashes during the Yatra (which we felt that mobs connected to the ruling dispensation could have engineered). In that sense, it was wise thinking on their part. But sadly, those targeted communities in Gujarat, Maharashtra, Muzaffarnagar and Delhi (whom civil society met separately in its own work and smaller yatras) did not have anyone to speak up for them. If the main Opposition parties have to be so